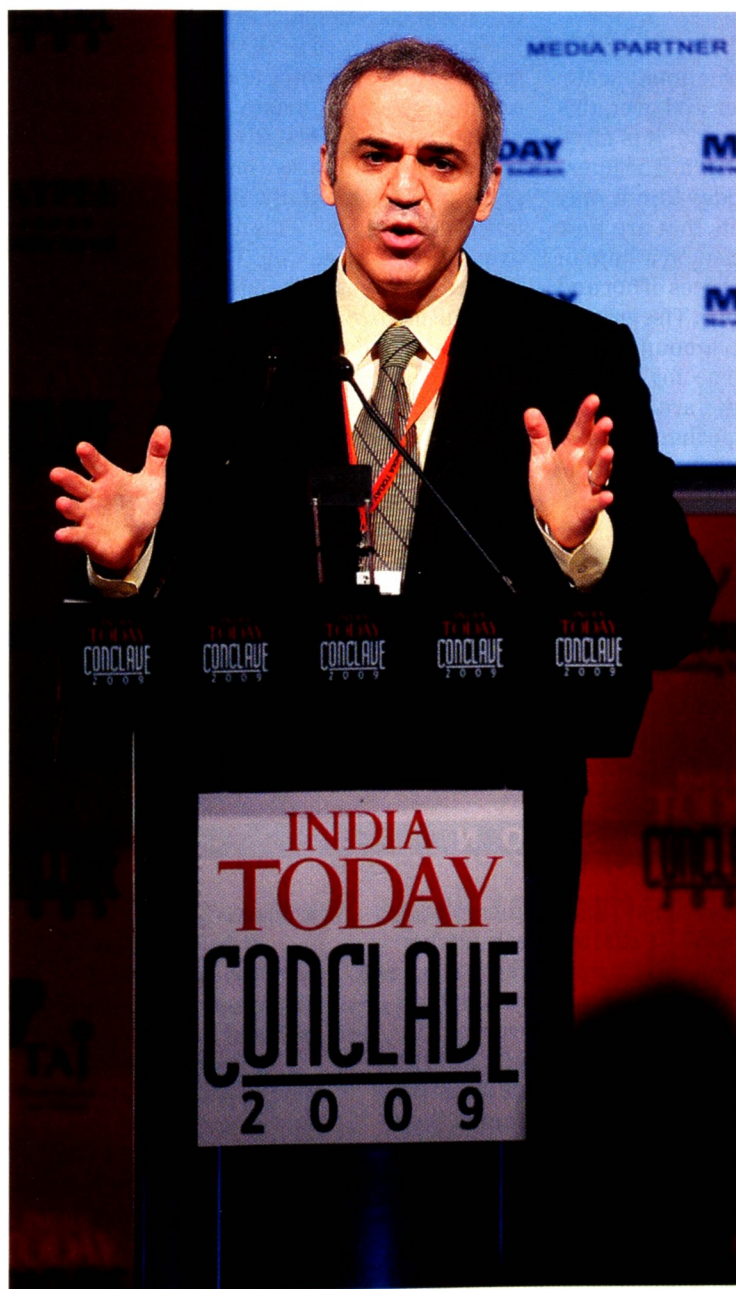


THE POLITICS OF CHANGE

“Maintaining status quo only postpones disaster”

GARRY KASPAROV FORMER WORLD CHESS CHAMPION AND POLITICAL ACTIVIST



REUBEN SINGH

The pleasant memories I had of my 1995 world championship match against my old friend and opponent Vishy Anand in New York were destroyed along with the World Trade Center, where the match took place. 9/11 sent a chilling message that the world was changing even if the great powers refused to acknowledge it. That is the first and most important message of change: it is happening whether you like it or not. You can ignore change, join it, or try to control it, but it is happening on a permanent and accelerating basis. Positive change is nearly impossible without courage, a word I will use many times here today. As Nehru said it well, “The policy of being too cautious is the greatest risk of all.”

When things look bad, maintaining the status quo can feel like a victory but usually it just

“THE FINANCIAL CRISIS AND THE GLOBAL REACH OF TERROR ARE NOT INCREMENTAL CRISES AND THEY WILL NOT BE SOLVED BY INCREMENTAL THINKING.”

GARRY KASPAROV

postpones disaster. Status quo can never be rescued; it can only be changed to your advantage or disadvantage. Attempting to postpone change, especially in the political realm, nearly always makes the inevitable crisis much worse. Famous moments in history—be it the first large civil rights march or the salt satyagraha—did not directly lead to changes in policy at that time. Their greatest impact was on the people they represented, to inspire them, to show resistance was possible.